

Spoiler alert: you will need to refine your plan every month and throughout each month! There will be categories you spend more on and others you spend less on from month to month because life never stays the same! How you shift and refine your spending plan is dependent on everything we've discussed already: your values, your season, your future goals, and all the tangible things you do to make better spending decisions.

There have been months where I (Jill) chose to spend less on dining out and entertainment and more on saving for my future emergencies until that category was fully funded (personally that means three months' worth of living expenses stashed away). And other times I spent more on food and bills and less on my sinking funds because we were hosting friends a lot or traveling. Both examples required some sacrifice and intentional decision-making, but both also bought me things I love like peace of mind and quality time with good friends.

Simplifying our space, schedule, routines, and budget are one aspect of curating our external environment. And every decision toward simplification in each of these categories can have a positive effect on our spending. But it doesn't stop here. Our external environment also includes our relationships and how our engagement with others can support all the good work we're doing with our money! That's next.

Lightning Round

What in my life feels the most complicated (space, schedule, routines, finances, etc.)? What's one thing I can do to simplify it?

Action Step

Make a simple spending plan for next month.
